



and remove any flowers. This will encourage the plant to divert its energy and attention into producing tubers. Remove any yellowing foliage in fall, and cut the stem back to about 4 in (10 cm) above ground level.

HARVESTING

Jerusalem artichoke tubers should be left in the ground and harvested as required—they don't keep very well once lifted. Ensure that all tubers are removed from the ground at the end of the season, since they will grow again the following year, and may become invasive.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Jerusalem artichokes are generally quite problem-free, but they may come under attack from slugs and snails. To deter these, use pellets, place beer traps around your plot, and lay a ring of sharp gravel, crushed eggshells, or copper tape as a barrier.

More rarely, white blister may affect crops. It causes whitish patches on the underside of leaves with yellow patches on the top. There is no cure for this fungus, so remove and destroy any affected plants, improve ventilation, and practice crop rotation.